HEADLINE JUDGMENT

Score HOLDS at 27/30 for an eleventh consecutive edition. No channel moved. The buyback rally lasted exactly one session, and what took it back was American economic data rather than anything that happened in the Gulf. On Thursday 20 August the 30-year rose **5.65 bp to 5.2476%**, giving back **62% of Wednesday's 9.15 bp fall** and leaving the tenor 5.84 bp below Monday's war high; the 10-year rose 5.75 bp to **4.7041%**; the dollar's three-month low lasted a single close. **Stage-4 Threshold B RE-ARMED on the very next close — the fifth arming and the ninth state since 29 July, and the THIRD time in this war that B has re-armed after exactly one session out, after 10 and 14 August.** §9.18 is now vindicated five times over and should be read as the governing rule rather than as a caveat. **The cause is on the tape and it is domestic:** the Philadelphia Fed's August manufacturing index printed **+47.4, which the Bank reports as a five-year high**, initial claims came in at **206,000**, an existing-home-sales beat at 4.05M and a leading index whose six-month growth rate turned positive. **A long end that fell 9 bp on a buyback announcement gave most of it back to a single strong American data day, which tells you what the buyback actually bought: a level, not a regime. Second, and it is the reconciliation that carries it: the Singapore snapshot understated every reconciled field bar one, all the same way, for the second time this month.** Brent settled **$1.92** above the print carried here on Thursday morning, and the curve settled **2.75 to 6.74 bp** above it across the 2- to 30-year. **Three readings the last edition took from that snapshot are withdrawn as TRENDS, not as facts about the 19 August close, which is unrestated and whose superlatives all hold (§9.20, §9.31): that Threshold B's lapse would persist, that the two legs of the Treasury downgrade were converging, and that the dollar had established a durable three-month low. Third, European gas took out its war-record CLOSE for the first time since 24 July.** TTF closed **€65.295**, above the €63.649 record close of 24 July, after two consecutive editions in which only the intraday print cleared it. **It is now 109.1% above its pre-war level while US Henry Hub sits 10.8% BELOW its own** — the cleanest single pair of numbers in this document for the proposition that this is a Hormuz routing dislocation and not a global energy shock. **Fourth, oil keeps closing in, and it is still the only live scoring question here.** Brent closed **$91.97 on the scored continuation, the highest since 24 July and a fifth consecutive up-close**; the active contract closed **$93.78, the highest since 23 July. The upgrade sits $3.03 away on the scored series and $1.22 on the active close — a fourth consecutive edition of narrowing.** Read the roll disclosure in 2.1 before treating either figure as a record proximity. **Fifth, Washington moved from blockade to declared economic war, and Tehran answered by pointing at the American bond market.** Trump announced an **'ECONOMIC D-DAY'** late on 19 August, after the last edition's Singapore cut, and Treasury Secretary Bessent told CNBC on 20 August that it is **'a one-two punch… we are going to collapse this regime'** and that on third countries **'you're either with us or against us'**, declining to say whether China would be targeted. Foreign Minister Araghchi's reply the same day called it **'a diversion from America's own crisis: unprecedented debt and surging interest costs'**. **That is a foreign minister naming the transmission channel this document exists to measure. And the sanctions that landed are not the sanctions that were trailed:** OFAC did act on 20 August, but on a Hizballah cash-smuggling network with three IRGC-Qods Force-linked designees — **no oil, no shipping, no ship registries, no exchange houses. Sixth, the frozen physical record broke. UKMTO published Update 087 on 20 August: the cumulative count moves 91 → 94** on three new incidents, and the document's own language changes — 086 said attack frequency 'has increased', 087 says it **'has remained consistent… and the environment reflects an established post-MoU status quo'**. The blockade tally moves to **65 redirected as of 19 August**. Against that, **CENTCOM's combat silence inside Iran reaches 23 days**, and the one thing it announced on 20 August — through press rather than its own releases index, and so Tier 2 — was the arrival of the USS George Washington. **Sequencing 27 → 27 → 27.**

1 · Live tape

Oil and natural gas — Bloomberg front-month / active

21 Aug 2026 readings are intraday prints from the Singapore Friday morning. The last confirmed close, and the scoring reference throughout, is **20 August**. d/d is the 20 Aug close against the 19 Aug close. w/w for the confirmed close runs against **13 Aug**, five sheet-rows back; the intraday row's own five-row base is **14 Aug**, and the two are labelled separately (§9.20). vs-pre-war is against the 27 Feb 2026 close, re-verified field by field and unchanged. **The §9.8 row check CLEARS decisively** — every populated field of the 20 Aug row differs from the snapshot published for it. **The field-level check under §9.35 RAISES ONE FLAG, and it is the 30-year again: see the UST table. Two roll and restatement events affect the WTI complex this edition and are disclosed in 2.1 rather than absorbed silently.**

Benchmark	Latest reading (basis in row)	∆ d/d (20 Aug close vs 19 Aug)	∆ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
Brent · 20 Aug close (last confirmed — the scoring reference)	**$91.97 /bbl**	**+$2.18 vs the 19 Aug close $89.79** (+$6.75 w/w vs 13 Aug)	from $72.48 (**+26.9%**) — a **$19.49/bbl premium**. **The highest Brent close since 24 July and a FIFTH consecutive up-close** (14, 17, 18, 19 and 20 Aug), which equals the five-close runs ending 23 July and 12 August; the war's longest is eight, ending 29 April. It leaves the channel **$3.03 below the $95 upgrade trigger and $19.49 above the $72.48 downgrade anchor**. **The upgrade gap has now narrowed in four consecutive editions** — 9.78, 8.43, 5.55, 5.21, **3.03**, which is four narrowings across five readings. Still $26.38 below the 31 Mar war high of $118.35	CO2 Comdty (Close)
Brent front-month · 21 Aug intraday	$91.51 /bbl (H 91.90 / L 91.28)	–$0.46 vs the 20 Aug close (+$4.94 w/w vs 14 Aug)	The Friday morning gives back a fifth of Thursday's gain in a 62-cent range. Active COA prints **$93.32**, which is **$1.68 from the $95 upgrade trigger**; the 20 Aug active CLOSE of **$93.78** is **$1.22 away and the highest active close since 23 July**. **An intraday print cannot move this channel (§4a) and no part of the score below uses one**	CO2 / COA Comdty

Benchmark	Latest reading (basis in row)	∆ d/d (20 Aug close vs 19 Aug)	∆ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
RECONCILIATION — the 20 August snapshot UNDERSTATED every reconciled field bar one, and in one direction	Brent closed $91.97 vs **$90.05** carried	**gap +$1.92**	**The mirror image of last edition, and near-one-directional in the way §9.31 was written for — every reconciled field bar Henry Hub settled the same way.** Every reconciled field bar one settled ABOVE the Singapore print: Brent **+$1.92**, COA +$1.81, TTF +€0.895, DXY +0.065, and across the curve **+2.75 bp on the 2-year, +5.49 on the 5-year, +6.74 on the 10-year and +6.38 on the 30-year**, with 2s10s +3.776, BE10 +4.52 and 5Y5Y +2.42. **No field is excluded this edition: all four tenors printed live values differing from the prior close, so §9.37 does not bite. THE ONE EXCEPTION IS HENRY HUB, which settled $0.051 BELOW its snapshot; it is named rather than dropped. WTI is not reconciled because this edition's roll and restatement break it, and Asia LNG, MOVE and VIX had no 20 Aug snapshot to measure against.** The 30-year gap of 6.38 bp is the **third-largest long-end reconciliation on record** behind 9.68 bp (19 Aug) and 7.59 bp (31 Jul). Running Brent gap series: +$0.72, +$0.87, –$0.13, +$1.29, +$2.60, –$0.45, **+$1.92**. Cause: the US macro releases and the 30-year TIPS auction all landed after the Singapore cut (§9.1). **WITHDRAWN AS TRENDS, NOT AS FACTS ABOUT 19 AUGUST (§9.20, §9.31): (a) B's lapse was real on the 19 Aug close and is counted as one of the nine states — but it re-armed on the very next close, so the LAPSE-WILL-HOLD reading is withdrawn; (b) the legs 'converged' at 19.11 bp on 19 Aug and the CONVERGENCE reading is withdrawn — the 30-year leg widened straight back out from 19.11 bp to 24.76; (c) the dollar's 'lowest close since 14 May' stands as a fact about 19 August but is withdrawn as a trend, the 20 Aug close having taken six hundredths of it back.** The 19 August closes themselves are unrestated and every superlative published about them holds	CO2 Comdty / derived
WTI front-month — **ROLL EVENT, and the apparent d/d is an artifact**	$84.37 /bbl (CL2)	20 Aug close **$86.83**, +$2.44 (+$6.39 w/w vs 13 Aug)	from $67.02 (**+29.6%**) on the 20 Aug close. **The scored CL2 continuation and the CLA active contract printed identical to the cent on EVERY session from 3 to 20 August and diverge by $1.93 today.** That is a contract roll, and the apparent –$2.46 move from Thursday's close to Friday's CL2 print is a **roll artifact, not a price move**: on the active contract the fall is **53 cents**, to $86.30. §9.36 applies and this is its first live occurrence. **Separately, the CLA column has been RESTATED across the whole 3–20 August window** — the 19 August active close this monitor published as $85.83 now reads $84.39 (§3)	CL2 / CLA Comdty
Brent–WTI spread	$5.14 /bbl front on the 20 Aug close	**$6.95 on the active contracts**, from $7.23 on 19 Aug	**Both legs are affected by this edition's roll and restatement and neither is offered as a clean series.** On the restated active basis the war high is **$7.23, set on 19 August**, so Thursday's $6.95 is a narrowing from a record set one session earlier and is **NOT itself a record**. The front-month spread of $5.14 is not comparable with Friday's $7.14, which spans the roll. **Reported as a watch item; no directional finding is claimed from it this edition**	derived
Henry Hub natural gas	$2.760 /MMBtu (21 Aug intraday)	20 Aug close **$2.733**, –$0.081 (+$0.006 w/w)	from $3.063 (**–10.8%**). **US gas is the control variable in this document.** It closed 10.8% BELOW its pre-war level on the same session that European gas closed 109.1% ABOVE its own — **and that TTF/Henry Hub pair is the load-bearing comparison, because both are exchange-settled and both are in this extract.** Asian LNG at +112.3% points the same way but is single-sourced and is cited as corroboration, not as evidence. **A global energy shock does not produce that dispersion; a chokepoint routing dislocation does**	NGA Comdty (Close)
TTF Dutch gas (active) — **NEW WAR RECORD CLOSE**	€64.855 /MWh (21 Aug intraday)	20 Aug close **€65.295**, +€1.914 (+€4.895 w/w)	from €31.227 (**+109.1%**). **This is the first CLOSE above the €63.649 record set on 24 July, and the first close above €65 of the war.** Two consecutive editions reported an intraday print above the record and declined to call it one; the close has now done it. The Friday intraday of €64.855 is below the new record and is not a second one. **Named drivers could NOT be sourced for the 19–20 August move specifically**; the standing structural drivers are Norwegian pipeline outages, with total exit nominations reported down near 50% from the early-August peak and the Ormen Lange outage extended to February 2027, plus Asian competition for cargoes	TZTA Comdty (Close)

Benchmark	Latest reading (basis in row)	∆ d/d (20 Aug close vs 19 Aug)	∆ vs pre-war close (27 Feb)	BBG ticker
Japan/Asia LNG (20 Aug close — no 21 Aug print)	¥3,543	+¥16 vs the 19 Aug close ¥3,527 (+¥176 w/w)	from ¥1,669 (**+112.3%**) — **the highest close since 24 July (¥3,593)** and a fifth consecutive rising print. No 21 Aug print; flagged and NOT carried as a reading (§9.2). **The level could not be corroborated outside the terminal and is single-sourced.** Hormuz normally moves roughly a fifth of global LNG (standing reference, unsourced this edition).	JGLA Comdty (Close)

US Treasuries and inflation expectations — Bloomberg

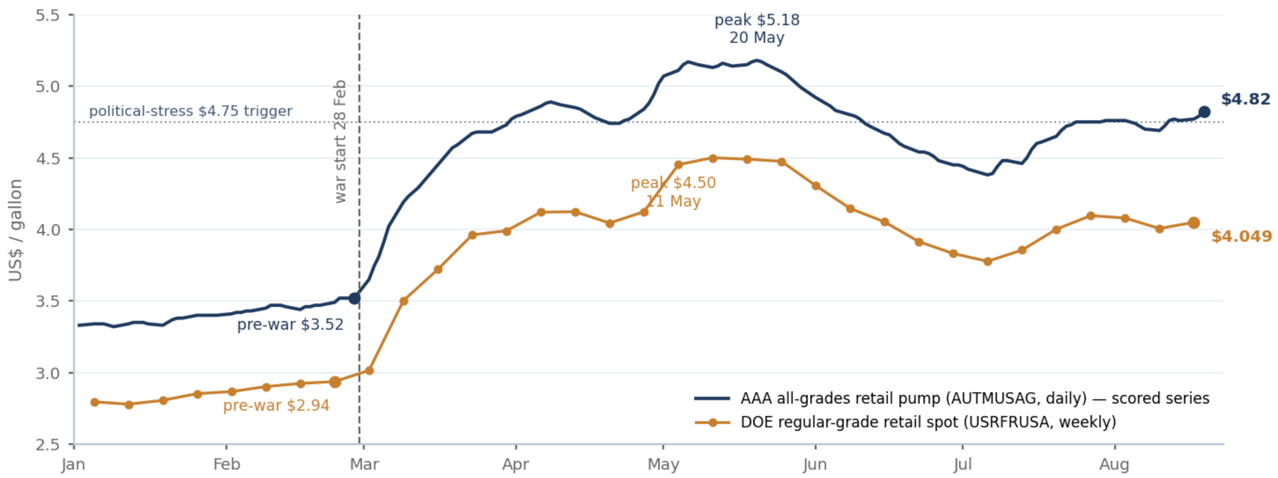
§9.35 FIRES, AND ON THE 30-YEAR FOR THE SECOND TIME. The 21 August row prints the 30-year at **5.2476%, identical to four decimal places to the 20 August close**, in a row where the 2-, 5- and 10-year and the 2s10s spread all moved. **Under the corrected rule that field is UNRESOLVED and NO day-on-day change is asserted for it** — which is precisely the configuration that concealed a war high on 17 August and forced the rule to be rewritten. Every other TENOR on the row is a live print; MOVE, VIX and SOFR have no 21 August print at all and are not carried. Triggers and Stage-4 tests run on the **20 Aug close**. **No UST row in the last three was restated on any field and no yield series backfilled. Two changes fall OUTSIDE the curve and are disclosed in 1 and 2.1: the WTI active column was restated across 3–20 August, and AUTMUSAG backfilled for 19 August. No other series changed.**

Tenor / measure	20 Aug close	∆ d/d	∆ w/w (vs 13 Aug)	Reading	21 Aug intraday
2-year	4.1875%	+2.52 bp	+4.51 bp	The short end participated this time, unlike Wednesday. **A strong data day moves the front end; a buyback announcement does not.** +81.26 bp vs pre-war	4.1811%
5-year	4.3904%	+4.78 bp	+7.40 bp	The largest w/w rise on the curve. +88.87 bp vs pre-war	4.3833%
10-year	**4.7041%**	**+5.75 bp**	+6.14 bp	**Back above 4.65% and above the 4.70% handle, and the leg that re-armed Threshold B.** It has now closed above 4.70% on three of the last five sessions. +76.66 bp vs pre-war	4.7001%
30-year	**5.2476%**	**+5.65 bp**	+3.51 bp	**Gives back 62% of Wednesday's 9.15 bp fall in one session, and is the largest one-day rise in the tenor since 31 July.** It leaves the 30-year **5.84 bp below Monday's war high of 5.3060%**, **3.16 bp ABOVE the 13 August auction stop of 5.216%** — having closed 2.49 bp below it a session earlier — and 19.76 bp above the 13 May stop. Still +63.70 bp vs pre-war	**UNRESOLVED (§9.35)**
2s10s (separate ticker; does not tie exactly to its legs)	51.235 bp	+3.226 bp	+1.414 bp	A bear steepener that reverses Wednesday's bull flattener by roughly two thirds. 4.41 bp flatter than pre-war	51.683 bp
10-year breakeven	**2.3525%**	**+4.47 bp**	+9.35 bp	**The highest close since 8 June and 9.56 bp above the 2.2569% pre-war anchor.** On 13 August this series sat 0.21 bp above that anchor and this document reported it as within a single basis point of going below pre-war for the first time in the war. **It is now nine and a half basis points the other way in five sessions.** Inflation compensation is rebuilding faster than nominal yields are	2.3529%
5y5y forward	2.3432%	+3.26 bp	+5.32 bp	**A FIFTH consecutive close above the 2.30% level whose sustained break fired this channel 4→5 on 31 July**, now by 4.32 bp — the widest clearance since 12 August. The documented downgrade at the 2.142% anchor is **20.12 bp away, WIDENED from 16.86** (§9.16, §9.26)	2.3415%
MOVE (rate volatility)	73.18	+1.92	+3.95	**Still below 75, for a third consecutive close** (74.98, 71.26, 73.18) — which equals the 12–14 August run as the longest of the current regime and is far short of the 21-session run of 10 Jun–10 Jul (§9.32). It is 0.20 below the 73.38 pre-war anchor, so the anchor comparison is now marginal rather than clear	**no print**
VIX	16.01	+1.12	+1.38	**The highest close since 4 August**, and 1.76 above the 14.25 series low of 14 August. Still 3.85 below the 19.86 pre-war level	**no print**
SOFR	**no 20 Aug print**	—	—	Blank on both 20 and 21 August, a second dark session. The last print is 3.62 on 19 August. Not carried (§9.9)	**no print**

Cross-asset stress and political-transmission gauges — Bloomberg and Tier 1 primary sources

Gauge	20 Aug close	∆ d/d	vs pre-war	What it says
DXY dollar index	98.895	**+0.062**	97.608 (+1.3%)	**The three-month low lasted exactly one close.** Wednesday's 98.833 was the lowest since 14 May and the fourth-largest one-day fall of the war; Thursday took six hundredths of it back and the 21 Aug intraday sits at 98.814, which is THROUGH Wednesday's low — but an intraday print cannot move this channel or set a record (§4a), and only a close can. **The claim withdrawn here is not the number but the trend read off it** — a currency that falls 0.824 on a supply-side announcement and does not extend has repriced a level, not a regime. The dollar is still 1.3% ABOVE its pre-war level after six months of war
MOVE / VIX	73.18 / 16.01	+1.92 / +1.12	73.38 / 19.86	**Both rose and MOVE is now only 0.20 below its pre-war anchor**, against 2.12 below a session earlier. Threshold C sits **56.82 points away**; the war high is 115.02 (26 March) and the series low 65.39 (18 June), so this is not the furthest from C the war has been (§9.32). The pairing still stands: rate volatility at its pre-war level while the 30-year sits **63.70 bp above its own**
AAA all-grades retail pump (scored)	**$4.82 (19 Aug)**	+3c vs 18 Aug	$3.52 (+36.9%)	**BACKFILLED — a new print the last edition did not have, and the highest since 5 June ($4.83).** It is **7 cents above the $4.75 trigger** that fired this channel to 5 on 4 August, and the named $4.60 downgrade condition is now **22 cents away, WIDENED from 19**. **No print for 20 or 21 August — two dark sessions, exactly as a fortnight ago (§9.30).** The series has risen on six of its last nine prints and fallen on three
AAA national averages (Tier 1, gasprices.aaa.com, read directly)	regular **$4.1044** · diesel **$5.5477**	+1.84c / +4.35c	n/a	**AAA diesel made a second consecutive war high on 20 August and is now 26.82 cents below its all-time record of $5.8159 (19 June 2022).** Diesel is up **14.34 cents on the week and 43.98 on the month** against regular's 3.29 and 10.12. AAA's own headline: 'High Crude Oil Prices Push Up National Average'. **Do not merge this with the scored AUTMUSAG series — different grades, different construction.** No 21 August publication at the time of writing
DOE weekly retail regular (corroboration)	$4.049 (week of 17 Aug)	unchanged this edition	~$2.94	The survey publishes Tuesdays and the next print is **25 August**; the on-highway diesel average is $5.454. **The values could not be re-verified outside the terminal for a second consecutive edition and are carried with that flag.** EIA no longer publishes 'This Week in Petroleum'
US front-month diesel crack	no published print for 19, 20 or 21 Aug	—	~$42.01 (27 Feb)	**No new record and no new print. The all-time high stands at $102.20 intraday on 17 August and a triple-digit settle on 18 August**, the first in history, per Bloomberg and corroborated by Reuters. **The derived ≈$101.2 figure this monitor computed for 19 August is NOT repeated as an observation**; no outlet has published a crack for any of the last three sessions. Distillate stocks remain **105.6 mn bbl, 13% below the five-year average**, on the 14 August EIA week. Two unresolved source conflicts persist: the pre-2026 record is $89 (Bloomberg) or $86.82 (DTN), and — as a standing item, since this edition makes no lowest-since stocks claim — the distillate comparison is 'since 1996' or 'since 1998'

US retail gasoline — the two tracked series, 2026 year-to-date



AUTMUSAG (AAA all-grades retail pump, daily) is the political-stress score reference (pre-war $3.52, peak $5.18, latest print **$4.82 on 19 Aug, backfilled this edition**; 20 and 21 Aug blank); USRFRUSA (DOE regular-grade retail spot, weekly) is nominally the corroborating series — though it has not been re-verifiable outside the terminal for two editions and is not currently corroborating anything (pre-war ~$2.94, peak $4.50, latest **$4.049 for the week of 17 Aug**). The dotted line is the $4.75 political→5 threshold. **The navy line has now closed above the trigger on six consecutive prints and is at its highest since 5 June.** The six-session decline that began at $4.75 on 4 August and ended at $4.69 on 10 August has been fully round-tripped: the series is thirteen cents above that low and seven cents above the level the decline started from. **The divergence that matters is inside the barrel, not between the two series:** AAA retail diesel rose 14.34 cents on the week against regular's 3.29, which is what a distillate shortage looks like by the time it reaches a forecourt.

Strait operational state

Item	State as at 21 Aug 2026	Source / tier
UKMTO / JMIC advisory — **UPDATE 087 PUBLISHED; THE FROZEN COUNT BREAKS**	**Update 087, dated 20 August (ICOD 201500Z), retrieved in full. Cumulative confirmed vessel incidents move from 91 to 94** on three new incidents since the last report. **The threat matrix is unchanged across all nine regions: Hormuz SEVERE, Gulf of Oman / Gulf of Aden / Bab el-Mandeb SUBSTANTIAL, Arabian Gulf, Arabian Sea, Somali Coast and North Red Sea MODERATE, East Med LOW. The material change is in the prose, not the matrix.** Where 086 said attack frequency 'has increased over the reporting period', 087 says it **'has remained consistent over the reporting period… and the environment reflects an established post-MoU status quo'**; VHF hailing goes from 'reduced reports' to 'occasional'. **CORRECTION TO THIS MONITOR'S RECORD: Update 086 is dated 18 August, not 17; the 17 August date attaches to the blockade tally inside it, not to the product. No Update 088 and no VRA Overview No.3 could be retrieved** — No.2 of 14 August remains current; 087 was obtained by direct file URL because the UKMTO indexes render empty to an anonymous fetch, so **both negatives are inconclusive rather than proven. Update 081 unretrievable for a seventh edition**	UKMTO/JMIC Update 087, read in full 21 Aug (Tier 1 primary)
The three new incidents — 116-26, 117-26, 118-26	**116-26 (logged 18 Aug) — ATTACK, STRAIT OF HORMUZ.** A bulk carrier, name withheld; OSINT reported a vessel attacked **on 15 August**, and a nearby vessel relayed VHF contact with the Master, who stated that **a rocket hit the starboard side under the gangway, with one confirmed crew fatality**. Vessel not under command; no environmental damage. **117-26 (18 Aug) — ATTACK, BAB EL-MANDEB. Six anti-ship ballistic missiles were fired at an anchored vessel in Yemeni territorial waters and five struck**, causing complete structural destruction; **no crew and no cargo were aboard**. **118-26 (20 Aug) — HIJACK, GULF OF ADEN**, the tanker SEAMULL (a.k.a. SIBU 1), Eritrea-flagged, 34NM off Yemen in the eastern IRTC; upgraded from attack to hijack at 0957Z with about six armed persons aboard stating an intent to proceed to Bosaso, Somalia. **118-26 is Somali-basin piracy and is segregated from the Hormuz count. UNRESOLVED AND REPORTED, NOT SMOOTHED: 115-26 (in 086) and 116-26 (in 087) are logged as two separate fatal attacks** — 115-26 an engine-room strike 0.5NM off Oman, 116-26 a rocket to the starboard side dated 15 August. Open-source reporting of the MINOAN DIGNITY shares elements with both. **The incident numbering says two; they are not merged here**	UKMTO 087 (Tier 1 primary) / INTERCARGO via Maritime Executive (Tier 2)
Hormuz transit counts — each provider on its own denominator, never averaged (§9.24)	**UKMTO annex (S&P/SeaVision), the only primary series, now extends to 19 August:** Hormuz cargo transits **0 (17 Aug), 1 (18 Aug), 0 (19 Aug)**; tankers **3 / 3 / 3 — a combined 3, 4 and 3 transits a day against the ~138/day 2025 baseline this annex is built on, which counts ALL transits, cargo and tanker together. US NCAGS-facilitated 42 over the 18–19 Aug 48 hours** — a facilitated subset, never added to the others. **Kpler via Al Jazeera (20 Aug), a PERIOD total and not a daily: 236 transits of all types across 1–19 August — 83 openly Iranian route, 3 openly Omani, 2 old central route, and 148 dark or unknown (62.7%)**; for oil and gas alone, **112 vessels of which 21 Iranian, 2 Omani and 89 dark (79.5%; Kpler's own summary rounds this to 'above 80%' and the arithmetic is printed here instead)**. Kpler's Mohamed Rafik Halitim: the dark share makes it **'highly difficult to determine what proportion may also have used the Omani route'**. **That is the provider, for the second consecutive edition, declining to make the claim the wire made for it. Windward (19 Aug): 16 contacts in 24 hours, 10 in / 6 out, of which 9 ran dark including 5 imagery-only with no AIS and no IMO — 'dark contacts now outnumber AIS-visible ones for the first time'. Lloyd's List (19 Aug, weekly): 73 transits for 10–16 August, preliminary and expected to revise UP, from 91 the prior week; cargo-carrying vessels above 10,000 dwt only.** IMF PortWatch still 1 for 16 August against its own ~73/day. **Nothing at all from TankerMap, LSEG or NCAGS for 20–21 August. HARD CAVEAT ON EVERY AIS-DERIVED FIGURE: Windward recorded 497 GPS-jammed vessels in the Persian Gulf on 19 August — 7.1% of 7,033 transmitting — and 1,418 false ship-to-ship meetings in one day, with blockade-breaker identity mismatches spiking to 24 of 74 matched vessels against a usual 1–2.** Three different pre-war baselines are now in circulation — ~138/day (UKMTO annex, all transits), ~130/day (Al Jazeera) and ~73/day (IMF PortWatch on its own chokepoint series) — and no percentage of normal is quoted here without naming which	UKMTO 087 annex (Tier 1) / Kpler via Al Jazeera, 20 Aug (Tier 1) / Windward and Lloyd's List, 19 Aug (Tier 1 provider) / IMF PortWatch (Tier 2)
Throughput — the Axios convoy claim now has a tracker sitting against it	**Axios (19 Aug, two unnamed US officials): a nightly US-escorted corridor along the southern Omani channel, 15–20 tankers each night, close to 10 mn b/d out of the strait, 'roughly half pre-war', run by a task force out of Fort Bragg. 'Roughly half' implies a ~20 mn b/d baseline; this document uses ~15 mb/d, on which 10 would be about two thirds. The denominators do not agree and are not reconciled.** It was picked up by seven outlets on 20 August and **every one traces to Axios; there is no independent Tier 1 verification, no DoD confirmation and no denial. The tension to report — and not to reconcile — is that Windward logged 16 total strait contacts in both directions across all cargo types on 19 August**, which is not obviously compatible with 15–20 tankers a night through one corridor unless nearly all of the convoy traffic is undetected. Against both: **Kpler puts crude clearance across the 60-day MoU window at 6.1 mb/d, about 40% of the ~15 mb/d Hormuz averaged in 2025**, and warns that its own most recent week revises up by a factor of 1.5 to 2.0 — **which is now a sourceable basis for this monitor's rule against computing a day-on-day off a same-day Kpler print.** Energy Secretary Wright's ~15 mn b/d has no update	Axios, 19 Aug (Tier 1, unnamed) / Windward and Kpler, 19 Aug (Tier 1 provider)
US naval blockade — the tally moves	**65 commercial vessels redirected, three disabled and two boarded as of 19 August**, attributed to US CENTCOM and reproduced verbatim in UKMTO Update 087 §2C — up from 64 as of 17 August. **CENTCOM is therefore publishing enforcement numbers through a channel other than its own public-releases index.** The '91 redirected' caption on CENTCOM's media page still conflicts with its own statement and is still NOT used. **The Washington Post report of 18 August that DoD is assessing a smaller Gulf footprint has produced no confirmation, denial or follow-through dated 20 or 21 August**, and no statement from Defense Secretary Hegseth could be sourced in the window; the standing formulation remains his 13 August 'indefinitely'	CENTCOM via UKMTO 087 §2C (Tier 1) / WaPo, 18 Aug (Tier 1 outlet, unnamed sourcing)

Item	State as at 21 Aug 2026	Source / tier
CENTCOM combat activity — 23 days, and the one thing it did announce	**The public-releases index was read directly. The most recent release describing a strike inside Iran is still 29 July — now a 23-day gap** — and the most recent release of any kind is 15 August, on the commander's regional trip. **There is no release dated 20 or 21 August. CENTCOM did nonetheless announce on 20 August that the USS George Washington has ARRIVED IN THEATRE** to relieve the USS Abraham Lincoln after 250-plus days — **but the strike group is still transiting the Arabian Sea toward the Gulf of Oman, so the relief is UNDER WAY and not complete**; the announcement came through press rather than the releases index, and is reported here as Tier 2 attributed to a CENTCOM statement. **Nothing at all on USS George H.W. Bush.** Note that the NEWS-ARTICLES index is stale to February 2026 and is not a usable channel — **the PUBLIC-RELEASES index is the primary source and must be the one queried**	centcom.mil public releases, read 21 Aug (Tier 1 primary) / Washington Examiner citing CENTCOM, 20 Aug (Tier 2)
Oman — **the mediator published on Hormuz for the first time in twelve days**	**Both fm.gov.om indexes were read directly and the exact queries are recorded (§9.23).** Most recent item of ANY kind: **20 August**, three items. Most recent **Iran/Hormuz news item: 20 August** — a joint press conference with Japanese Foreign Minister Motegi at which both **'called for intensified international efforts to ensure freedom of navigation through the Strait of Hormuz'**, with Badr Albusaidi saying **'lasting security in the Strait of Hormuz requires a lasting peace in the region'** and Motegi that **'the situation concerning Iran is at a highly critical stage'**. **The item mentions neither the United States, nor the blockade, nor the bilateral Iran–Oman track.** Most recent **Hormuz statement: 14 July**; most recent **Oman–Iran joint statement: 23 June**. **The joint declaration has still NOT been issued and Qatar's gate has not opened. Oman has still published nothing on the 14 August attacks in its own territorial waters and nothing on being threatened with US bombardment.** Separately, its own index records **the Sultan visiting the UAE on 17 August — two days before the UAE announced, on 19 August, that all trade, commercial exchanges and financial transactions with Iran were halted until further notice (UAE MFA, Tier 1)**	fm.gov.om, both indexes read 21 Aug (Tier 1 primary)
Red Sea and the wider periphery	**Bab el-Mandeb transits ROSE: 71 vessels over the 18–19 August 48 hours, against 59 over 16–17 August** — about 35/day against a ~61/day 2023 baseline. **Al-Mokha remains completely closed.** The one confirmed Red Sea incident in 087, 117-26, destroyed an **unmanned, cargo-less** hull. **The Houthi claim to have struck Aramco's Jazan refinery on 18 August is now in its fourth day with no Saudi or Aramco comment and no Tier 1 corroboration — carried as a CLAIM only**, unlike the confirmed 9 August strike. **SIX vessels are now under pirate control** — HONOUR 25, SWARD, EUREKA, ASANA, LUTUF and, from 20 August, SEAMULL — **and every one of them is Somali-basin piracy, kept strictly segregated from the Hormuz count. NO kinetic event anywhere in the Hormuz theatre is dated 20 or 21 August**, and a Tier 2 aggregator puts at **21** the run of nights with no US or Israeli strike inside Iran and no acknowledged coalition air operation anywhere in theatre. **That count excludes vessel attacks and is a different measure from the UKMTO incident count, which rose by three in the same window. A circulating attribution of an ADNOC-vessel attack to Friday 21 August is REJECTED: the source page is dated 14 August, which was also a Friday**	UKMTO 087 (Tier 1) / GlobalSecurity daily update, 20 Aug (Tier 2) / SABA (Tier 3), uncorroborated

2 · US economic shock — analysis with bond yields

2.1 · Bond-yield transmission, channel by channel

(i) What the market did. (ii) What it means for the channel. (iii) What would change the score. All tests run on the **20 August close**, the last confirmed one. **Thursday is a clean session to read and it should be read as a macro session, not a war session.** Four US releases landed before noon, every one at or above consensus, and the long end sold off through them; the $8bn 30-year TIPS reopening cleared at 1pm. **No Gulf-originating headline is named as a driver of US yields in any 20 August market wrap this desk retrieved; every named attribution is domestic.**

(2) Oil price shock — held at 2/5, and a fourth consecutive narrowing of the upgrade gap
(i) Brent closed **$91.97** on the scored CO2 continuation, up $2.18 and the fifth consecutive up-close, **the highest since 24 July**; the active contract closed **$93.78, the highest since 23 July**. WTI closed $86.83. **(ii)** The upgrade trigger is a sustained Brent close above $95 and it is **$3.03 away on the scored series and $1.22 on the active close** — the narrowest either has been since the July roll, and a fourth consecutive edition of narrowing (9.78, 8.43, 5.55, 5.21, 3.03). **The named attributions this week are to policy and to risk perception, not to any physical event this document can date. Note that the first named attribution explains an ABSENCE OF DECLINE rather than the rise:** Rystad's Susan Bell told Reuters that **'despite the bearish crude stock data, the broader geopolitical backdrop is preventing a sharper price decline'**; SEB's Bjarne Schieldrop attributes the rise to a US approach that implies little hope of near-term resolution; and the most-cited proximate driver in Thursday's wraps is **Bessent's restatement of the 'toughest sanctions in history' threat**. **(iii)** Sustained closes above $95 take the channel to 3 and the score to 28. **§4(a) is decisive and is about to be tested: the trigger requires sustained closes, not a touch, and with the active contract $1.22 away a single print through $95 will not move this score.** The downgrade leg — a mediated pause and a close at or below $72.48 — is $19.49 away on price and unavailable on process.
ROLL DISCLOSURE — §9.36 has its first live occurrence, on WTI, and a restatement arrives with it. The scored CL2 continuation and the CLA active contract printed **identical to the cent on every session from 3 to 20 August** and diverge by **$1.93** on the 21 August row. **The apparent –$2.46 day-on-day move in WTI is therefore a roll artifact and is not reported as a price move**; on the active contract the fall is 53 cents. Separately, **the CLA column has been RESTATED across the whole 3–20 August window**: the 19 August active close this monitor published as $85.83 now reads $84.39, and the active Brent–WTI spread is consequently not comparable with the figures published before 21 August. **On Brent the position is unchanged from last edition and must be restated because it governs every distance quoted above:** the scored CO2 continuation closed **$100.69 on 23 July and $96.78 on 24 July**, two consecutive closes above the $95 trigger, while the ACTIVE contract closed $94.26 and $91.68 on the same two days, below it. **The correct formulation remains that the last two closes above $95 sit on the far side of a July roll on which the active contract never cleared the trigger, and that every distance in this edition is measured on the current post-roll basis. The CO2/COA basis — the continuation minus the active contract, which is a different quantity from the reconciliation gaps on page 2 and happens to share a figure with them — has narrowed from $1.92 below on the 20 Aug intraday to $1.81 below on the 20 Aug close, so the two measures are converging rather than diverging** — which matters, because at $1.22 the active gap is now the binding one on any reading. This remains an open methodological item.

(3) US inflation impulse — held at 5/5, and the downgrade gap widened back out
(i) 5Y5Y closed **2.3432%**, up 3.26 bp and **a fifth consecutive close above the 2.30% level whose sustained break fired this channel 4→5 on 31 July**, now clear by 4.32 bp — the widest since 12 August. **BE10 closed 2.3525%, the highest since 8 June and 9.56 bp above the 2.2569% pre-war anchor. (ii)** The documented downgrade is a sustained close at or below the 2.142% anchor, **20.12 bp lower — WIDENED from 16.86**. **The breakeven series is the one to read this week, and it is why this channel's 5/5 reads comfortably against the tape even as the documented downgrade gap widens. The §9.16 and §9.26 tension is not resolved by that; it is 3.26 bp worse.** On 13 August this document reported BE10 at 0.21 bp above its pre-war anchor and said a single basis point would put spot inflation compensation below pre-war for the first time in the war. **Five sessions later it is 9.56 bp the other way** — a 9.35 bp rise on the week, against 3.51 bp on the 30-year nominal. **Inflation compensation is rebuilding faster than nominal yields are, which is the opposite composition to Wednesday's buyback session and is consistent with a diesel crack that has been at a record and a retail diesel price making consecutive war highs. (iii)** Sustained closes at or below 2.142% take the channel to 4 and the score to 26. Nothing else moves it, and the move required has grown by 3.26 bp in one session.

(4) Treasury stress — held at 5/5; the legs rotated apart again and Threshold B re-armed
(i) The 30-year closed **5.2476%**, up 5.65 bp — **the largest one-day rise in the tenor since 31 July, and a give-back of 62% of Wednesday's fall in a single session**. MOVE rose 1.92 to **73.18**, still below 75 but only 0.20 below the pre-war anchor. **(ii)** The downgrade needs the 30-year below 5.00% **with** MOVE below 75, sustained. **The volatility leg is satisfied for a third consecutive close, the equal-longest run of the current regime. The 30-year leg fails by 24.76 bp — WIDENED straight back out from 19.11. Last edition reported both legs converging for the first time since 13 August; that conclusion is withdrawn, and §9.15 stands: these legs rotate, they do not converge. The forward-looking point is §9.18 and it has now been demonstrated five separate times:** the MOVE leg was satisfied on the 5 and 7 August closes and lost on the next session each time, and Threshold B has re-armed after a single session out on 10 August, on 14 August, and now again. **The correct posture toward any single long-end session in this war is that it does not survive contact with the next one. (iii)** A sustained 30-year below 5.00% with MOVE below 75 takes the channel to 4 and the score to 26. On these levels that requires another 24.76 bp, 5.65 more than a session ago.

(5) Political stress — held at 5/5; the scored series backfilled UP to its highest since 5 June
(i) AUTMUSAG **backfilled to $4.82 for 19 August** — a print the last edition did not have, **the highest since 5 June ($4.83)**, and seven cents above the $4.75 trigger that fired this channel to 5 on 4 August. **No print for 20 or 21 August: two dark sessions, exactly the configuration of a fortnight ago.** AAA's own national averages, a different and unscored construction read directly from the source, put regular at **$4.1044** and diesel at **$5.5477** on 20 August, the latter **a second consecutive war high and 26.82 cents below the all-time record of $5.8159**. **(ii)** The named downgrade condition — three consecutive closes at or below $4.60 with no intervening print above $4.70 — is **22 cents away and has WIDENED from 19**. **§9.30 has now been demonstrated twice in a fortnight and in the same direction: dark sessions backfill UP, and a trend read through them is not a trend.** The transmission runs through the distillate barrel and is intact:

retail diesel rose 14.34 cents on the week against gasoline's 3.29, and 43.98 cents on the month against 10.12. **(iii)** The named condition, met three times running, takes the channel to 4 and the score to 26.

(1) Maritime denial and (6) Escalation risk — both held at 5/5, and both are scale-capped
Neither channel can rise. **§4(c) applies and must be stated plainly: further deterioration in the physical or political situation cannot raise this score, so a flat number is an artifact of the scale rather than a statement about stability. This edition is the cleanest illustration yet, because the two channels moved in opposite directions and the total could register neither.** On maritime denial the record worsened: **Update 087 adds three incidents and takes the cumulative count from 91 to 94**, with a rocket attack and a crew fatality in the strait itself. On escalation the kinetic record is emptier than at any point in weeks — **no kinetic event anywhere in the Hormuz theatre dated 20 or 21 August, a 23-day CENTCOM combat silence, a carrier relief under way without reported incident (Tier 2), and UKMTO's own assessment that attack frequency 'has remained consistent' in what it calls an 'established post-MoU status quo'** — while the economic front escalated to a declared objective of regime collapse. **An embargo, a sanctions threat and a stated intent to collapse a government are not kinetic events and are not scored as ones (§9.11); they are scored as what they remove from the negotiating space, which is why they show up in the scenario map rather than in the total.**

2.2 · Stage-4 thresholds

Threshold	Test	State on the 20 Aug close
A — auction failure	A coupon auction clearing with a tail above its when-issued level (§9.33). Reference: the 13 May 30-year, cleared 5.050%; the 13 August 30-year, cleared 5.216%	**NOT ARMED — and the standing question from last edition is now ANSWERED in a way that makes the test UNTESTABLE AS WRITTEN rather than merely unverified. Treasury's own primary results for the 19 August 20-year were retrieved this edition via the Fiscal Data auctions API (release R_20260819_2, CUSIP 912810UX4).** Bid-to-cover of **2.53 is CONFIRMED exactly**; the high yield is **5.2040%**. **The 62.9% indirect share this monitor carried as single-sourced is CORRECT — on the competitive-accepted denominator, where it is 62.93%. On total award ex-SOMA it is 62.17%. It was a denominator artifact, not an error (§9.19 applies to auction allotments too). THE 0.5 bp TAIL CANNOT BE CONFIRMED FROM ANY TREASURY SOURCE, because Treasury does not publish a when-issued level at all.** Last edition left A conditional on primary confirmation of that tail; **the honest answer is that no such confirmation can ever exist, so the condition is untestable as written and §9.21 and §9.33 require it to be replaced rather than left pending. That is recorded as an open item and not disposed of here. §9.29 says read the bid composition, and it is where the story is: primary dealers took just 12.34% of the 20-year award, and on the $8bn 30-year TIPS reopening the next day they took 2.09% — tendering $11.9bn and being awarded $167m — against indirects at 83.85% and a bid-to-cover of 2.82.** That TIPS cleared a real yield of **2.9730%**, described by Tipswatch (Tier 2) as the highest for the tenor since October 2001. **Two consecutive long-end auctions cleared with minimal dealer participation — indirects at 62.93% and 83.85%, dealers at 12.34% and 2.09% — and neither allotment split appeared in any wire report this desk could retrieve; the figures here come from Treasury's own release data.** Context: the 30-year closed **3.16 bp ABOVE the 13 August stop** and 19.76 bp above the 13 May stop
B — 30Y above 5.20% with 10Y above 4.65%	Both legs, on confirmed closes	**RE-ARMED on the 20 August close, after exactly one session out. The 30-year clears by 4.76 bp and the 10-year by 5.41 bp.** This is the **FIFTH arming and the ninth state** since 29 July — in 29 Jul–3 Aug, out 4–5 Aug, in 6 Aug, out 7 Aug, in 10–12 Aug, out 13 Aug, in 14–18 Aug, out 19 Aug, **in 20 Aug**. Five armings, four lapses. **Count armings, not cycles. The lapse that just ended lasted a single session and was decided by 0.89 and 0.34 bp — the narrowest margins of the war — which is exactly why §9.18 exists. This is the THIRD time B has re-armed within one session, after 10 and 14 August; the 6 August re-arming followed a TWO-session lapse and is not one of them.** The inference that has held since 13 August still holds and gets stronger with every cycle: **4.65% and 5.20% are the middle of the distribution, not its edge**, and all eight state changes have been decided by under 6 bp on one leg
C — MOVE above 130	On confirmed closes	**73.18 on the 20 August close, 56.82 points below**, having risen 1.92. The war high is 115.02 (26 March) and the series low 65.39 (18 June), so this is **NOT the furthest from C the war has been** (§9.32). **The pairing has narrowed on one side and widened on the other: rate volatility is now only 0.20 below its pre-war anchor, against 2.12 below a session ago, while the 30-year sits 63.70 bp above its own, against 58.05.** This is a market that has priced the movement out of rates while the level of the long bond has gone further from normal

2.3 · The macro session that took the rally back, and the economic war that was declared over it

Four US releases landed on the morning of 20 August and every one of them came in at or above consensus. The **Philadelphia Fed's August manufacturing index printed +47.4**, which the Philadelphia Fed reports as a **five-year high**, from 41.4 in July — a very large upside surprise on any of the consensus figures in circulation, which ranged from 6.3 to 25.0, and **the spread of those consensus figures is itself a caveat on how big the 'surprise' was. Initial jobless claims fell 6,000 to 206,000. Existing home sales came in at 4.05M SAAR** against a 3.94M consensus, a second consecutive monthly decline but a beat, with the median price at $434,100 and a 37th straight month of annual gains. **The Conference Board's leading index rose 0.2%** and its six-month growth rate turned positive at +0.2% from –1.3%. **The long end sold off through all of it, which is the ordinary and expected response and is precisely why it matters here: it means Wednesday's 9 bp rally was not a repricing of risk but a repricing of supply, and one strong data day was enough to take most of it back. A Fed official said the same thing in different words, speaking only for himself.** St. Louis's Alberto Musalem told CNBC on 20 August that the bond selloff reflects **'a competition for capital… from government financing… plus the AI build-out'** and **not** a Fed credibility problem; that policy is still **'accommodative'** with the real funds rate below neutral; and that underlying inflation is running **2.5–3%** against a 2% target. **He declined to prejudge September. September pricing sits at roughly a 68% hold on a 20 August reading — but that figure comes through a secondary aggregator citing CME FedWatch, not from CME directly, and no clean datestamped CME print could be sourced for a second consecutive edition. Jackson Hole runs 27–29 August on 'Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy', with Chair Warsh's first keynote on Friday 28 August** — nineteen days before the 16 September FOMC; **the Kansas City Fed's own programme still could not be retrieved and the agenda remains Tier 2**. GDPNow is unchanged at **4.0% for Q3, dated 18 August**, with the next revision on 26 August. **On the economic-war track, the rhetoric ran well ahead of the instrument.** Trump announced an **'ECONOMIC D-DAY'** late on 19 August New York time — after the last edition's Singapore cut — warning that **any** country whose financial institutions, airports, ship registries or exchange houses provide Iran a lifeline will face ‘tremendous economic consequences’, naming oil smuggling, swap lines, cash transfers, exchange houses, ship registries and front companies. Bessent followed on CNBC on 20 August: **‘It is a one-two punch. We have the blockade, and we are going to have the toughest sanctions in history… we are going to collapse this regime’**, and on third countries **‘you’re either with us or against us’**. He **declined to say whether China would be targeted**, noting that the Chinese take about half their energy from inside the Gulf. **What actually issued on 20 August is not that package.** OFAC’s action of that date designates **ten individuals in a Hizballah cash-smuggling network, three of them tagged as linked to the IRGC-Qods Force, and amends Hizballah’s own SDN entry to carry an IRGC-QF designation**. **There is no Iranian oil, shipping, refinery, bank, ship-registry or vessel designation, no Iran-related executive order and no new general licence; the designees are mostly Turkey-based and two carry UAE addresses, and the only vessels added that day are Ecuadorian fishing boats under the counter-narcotics programme. On the third day after ‘Economic D-Day’, on this document’s inclusive count, the Hormuz-facing sanctions remain undelivered.** China’s foreign ministry said on 20 August that **‘imposing sanctions and pressuring do not help to solve the issue’**. **On the regional track, Majlis Speaker Ghalibaf’s three-day visit to Iraq, which opened in Baghdad on 19 August and takes in Karbala and Najaf, concludes on Friday 21 August; no readout from the Karbala or Najaf legs has been published** (The National and Asharq Al-Awsat, 19 Aug, Tier 1/Tier 2). **A single-sourced report that he discussed an Iranian plan to conceal militia weapons is confirmed by neither government and is NOT used.** Iran’s answer came from Araghchi the same morning: the ‘so-called Economic D-Day’ is **‘a diversion from America’s own crisis: unprecedented debt and surging interest costs’**. **Whatever its motive, it names the transmission channel this document tracks, and it is the government the mechanism is aimed at that named it. The characterisation of the debt level as ‘unprecedented’ is Araghchi’s and is not tested here. Elsewhere on the energy and freight record, most of the standing figures did not refresh and are labelled rather than rolled forward. No EIA, IEA, OPEC or OPEC+ release dated 20 or 21 August**; the next OPEC+ meeting is 6 September and **effective OPEC spare capacity of 0.07 mb/d, a 3Q26 deficit of 1.8 mb/d and 8.3 mb/d shut in all survive unrevised**. The **Baltic week-34 tanker averages could not be retrieved and are reported as not obtained, NOT as unchanged**; week 33 was VLCC $234,821/day, Suezmax $269,824/day and Aframax $77,182/day. **Lloyd’s List assessed TD3C MEG–China above $520,000/day on 19 August** — a single route, never comparable with the global VLCC average, and Lloyd’s List itself has described Middle East VLCC index rates in this crisis as thinly underpinned. **War-risk cover still has nothing newer than Marsh’s 7.5–10% of hull of 22 July**; a ‘3–8% of vessel value’ range circulating as industry estimate has no named broker and is not used, and straits.live’s ‘40x normal’ is its own model, not a quote. **The covert relay is unchanged rather than deepened:** Windward reported on 19 August that **two Hong Kong-flagged, Chinese-managed tankers aborted Hormuz transits within 24 hours**, one broadcasting ‘CHINESE CREW OWNER’ in its AIS destination field, and that China’s two largest state operators are keeping fleets out of both chokepoints on Beijing’s guidance; **Kharg saw its first terminal activity in 23 days**, a dark vessel at the sulphur and LPG berth — **‘a marginal signal… not yet a clear reversal’**. **Iranian crude loadings remain 156 kb/d through 17 August against 893 kb/d in July, and crude on water in the Mideast Gulf and Gulf of Oman 110 mn bbl on 18 August; neither has a 20 or 21 August update. DP World is spending about $100m a month keeping Jebel Ali ready to reopen against container throughput at roughly 10% of pre-crisis levels**, and ADNOC L&S has disclosed $1.3bn of VLCC and VLGC purchases — **balance-sheet positioning for a long closure.**

3 · Shock score

Six channels, 0–5 each, summed 0–30. Bands: 0–7 watch · 8–14 stress · 15–21 systemic-risk watch · **22–30 crisis**. Market channels move only on confirmed closes; event channels move only on events, not announcements (§9.11). Hysteresis is asymmetric by design: upgrades on a sustained break, downgrades only on a sustained reversal past a wider threshold.

Channel	Score	Basis for this edition	Move
1 · Maritime denial	5 / 5	Day 175. **Update 087 published 20 Aug: the cumulative count moves 91 → 94** on three new incidents, including **a rocket attack in the strait with one crew fatality** and a Bab el-Mandeb strike in which six ASBMs were fired at an unmanned hull. Hormuz SEVERE; all nine threat levels unchanged. **The annex now extends to 19 Aug: Hormuz cargo 0/1/0 and tankers 3/3/3 across 17–19 Aug** against a ~138/day baseline. Kpler: 148 of 236 August transits dark or unknown.	held (at max)
2 · Oil price shock	2 / 5	Brent closed **$91.97** on 20 Aug, a fifth consecutive up-close and the highest since 24 July; the active contract closed **$93.78**, the highest since 23 July. **$3.03 below the $95 upgrade on the scored series, $1.22 on the active close, and $19.49 above the $72.48 downgrade. The upgrade gap has narrowed in four consecutive editions.** Sustained closes, not a touch (§4a).	held — **the only channel that can move the score UP**
3 · US inflation impulse	5 / 5	**A FIFTH consecutive 5Y5Y close above 2.30%**, at 2.3432%, 4.32 bp clear. **BE10 at 2.3525% is the highest since 8 June and 9.56 bp above its pre-war anchor**, from 0.21 bp on 13 August. The 2.142% downgrade is **20.12 bp away, WIDENED from 16.86**. Musalem puts underlying inflation at 2.5–3%.	held (at max)
4 · Treasury stress	5 / 5	**The 30-year rose 5.65 bp to 5.2476%, giving back 62% of Wednesday's buyback rally on a strong US data day, and Threshold B RE-ARMED after one session out.** MOVE 73.18 satisfies the volatility leg for a third close; **the 30-year leg fails by 24.76 bp, WIDENED from 19.11.** The legs rotated apart again (§9.15).	held (at max)
5 · Political stress	5 / 5	AUTMUSAG **backfilled to $4.82 for 19 Aug — the highest since 5 June** and 7 cents above the $4.75 trigger; no 20 or 21 Aug print. The $4.60 condition is **22 cents away, WIDENED from 19**. **AAA diesel made a second consecutive war high at $5.5477 on 20 Aug**, 26.82 cents below its all-time record, up 14.34 cents on the week against gasoline's 3.29.	held (at max)
6 · Escalation risk	5 / 5	**Washington declared an 'Economic D-Day' and the Treasury Secretary said on CNBC that 'we are going to collapse this regime'**, with third countries told 'you're either with us or against us'. **But the sanctions that issued on 20 Aug are a Hizballah cash network, not the Hormuz package**, and the kinetic record is empty: **no event dated 20 or 21 Aug, a 23-day CENTCOM combat silence, and UKMTO calling it an 'established post-MoU status quo'.**	held (at max)
TOTAL	**27 / 30**	**CRISIS band. Eleventh consecutive edition at 27.** Five of six channels are pinned at the top of the scale and the sixth, oil, is three points below it. **This edition is the sharpest illustration of the saturation problem yet, because the two capped channels moved in OPPOSITE directions** — the incident count rose by three while the kinetic record went empty for a 21st night — **and the total could register neither, nor a Treasury Secretary saying on television that the intent is to collapse the Iranian government.** Read the composition, not the total (§9.7, §9.27).	**27 → 27 → 27**

4 · What has changed since the 20 August edition

1 · The buyback rally was given back in one session, by American data. The 30-year rose 5.65 bp to 5.2476% and the 10-year 5.75 bp to 4.7041% on a morning that produced a five-year high in the Philadelphia Fed index (+47.4), initial claims of 206,000, an existing-home-sales beat at 4.05M and a leading index whose six-month growth rate turned positive. **The 2-year rose 2.52 bp — it participated this time, where it moved less than one basis point on Wednesday**, which is the signature difference between a data session and a supply session. **2 · Threshold B re-armed after exactly one session out** — the fifth arming, the ninth state since 29 July, and the THIRD one-session round trip, after 10 and 14 August. **3 · The 20-year auction internals are RESOLVED against primary Treasury data, and the tail is resolved as unobtainable.** Bid-to-cover of 2.53 is confirmed exactly; the 62.9% indirect share is correct on the competitive-accepted denominator (62.17% on total award); **and the 0.5 bp tail cannot be confirmed by Treasury at all, because Treasury publishes no when-issued level.** Last edition made Threshold A conditional on that confirmation. **The condition is untestable as written and is recorded as an open item requiring replacement. 4 · Two long-end auctions in two days cleared with almost no dealer participation.** Primary dealers took **12.34%** of the 20-year and **2.09%** of Thursday's $8bn 30-year TIPS, which cleared a real yield of **2.9730%** — the highest for the tenor since October 2001 per Tipswatch (Tier 2) — with indirects at 83.85% and a bid-to-cover of 2.82. **5 · TTF set a new record CLOSE at €65.295**, taking out the €63.649 record close of 24 July, while Henry Hub closed 10.8% below its own pre-war level. **6 · Brent closed at its highest since 24 July, the active contract at its highest since 23 July, and the upgrade gap narrowed for a fourth consecutive edition to $3.03 and $1.22. 7 · UKMTO Update 087 was published on 20 August and the frozen count broke: 91 → 94.** Three incidents — a rocket attack in the strait with a crew fatality dated 15 August, six ASBMs at an unmanned hull in Bab el-Mandeb, and the hijack of the tanker SEAMULL in the Gulf of Aden on 20 August. **The document's own language moves from attack frequency 'has increased' to 'has remained consistent… an established post-MoU status quo'**, and the blockade tally moves to **65 redirected as of 19 August**. **8 · Washington moved from blockade to declared economic war.** Trump's 'Economic D-Day' on 19 August and Bessent's 20 August 'we are going to collapse this regime' and 'you're either with us or against us', with China explicitly not ruled out. **Araghchi**

answered by naming US debt and interest costs. China's foreign ministry rejected the approach. **9 · The sanctions that landed are not the sanctions that were trailed.** OFAC acted on 20 August on a Hizballah cash-smuggling network with three IRGC-QF-linked designees; **no Iranian oil, shipping, registry, bank or vessel designation, and no Iran-related executive order. Correcting a likely inference from last edition's watchlist: it is not true that OFAC took no action — it is true that the action is not the Hormuz package. 10 · Oman published on Hormuz for the first time since 8 August**, jointly with Japan's foreign minister on 20 August, calling for freedom of navigation. **§9.23 again: the negative claim decayed and was re-checked rather than carried.** The Iran–Oman joint declaration is still not issued and Qatar's gate has not opened. **11 · CENTCOM's combat silence inside Iran reaches 23 days, and it announced the USS George Washington's ARRIVAL on 20 August** — outside its own public-releases index, so the arrival is carried as Tier 2 attributed to a CENTCOM statement. **12 · Three data-integrity results.** The §9.8 row check **clears decisively**. **§9.35 FIRES on the 30-year for a second time** — the 21 August print is identical to four decimals to the 20 August close in an otherwise live row, and is reported UNRESOLVED with no day-on-day asserted. **And §9.36 has its first live occurrence: the WTI continuation rolled on 21 August after fourteen sessions of identity with the active contract, so the apparent –$2.46 move is an artifact; the CLA column was also restated across the whole 3–20 August window. 13 · Withdrawals and corrections**, itemised in full in the source log: three readings from the 20 August edition withdrawn as trends; **UKMTO Update 086 redated to 18 August**; the derived diesel crack not repeated; **an ADNOC-vessel attack dated Friday 21 August REJECTED, the source page being 14 August, also a Friday**; and a '17.4 mn bbl' crude build attributed to ING rejected as a garble of the 17.4 mn b/d refinery-input line, the actual build being 4.4 mn. The Houthi Jazan claim is in its fourth day uncorroborated.

5 · Scenario map

Scenario	Prob.	Description	Shift from 20 Aug and why
Deal collapse on terms	**44%**	Modal for an eighth consecutive edition. The strait stays shut not because talks failed to start but because the terms are irreconcilable: Iran demands sanctions relief, released assets, an end to the blockade and a halt to operations on all fronts; the US demands restored free passage, no nuclear weapons and no proxy funding, and is running a blockade to compel it.	**+1 (43 → 44). The US Treasury Secretary said on the record, on CNBC, that 'we are going to collapse this regime' — a statement of posture rather than a published policy objective, and treated as posture here (§9.11).** A counterparty whose declared aim is your collapse is not a counterparty you converge with, and Bessent's 'either with us or against us' extends the same logic to third states. **Held to +1 because the instrument lags the rhetoric** — the sanctions that actually issued on 20 August were a Hizballah cash network, not the Hormuz package.
Return to full war	**23%**	Sustained US or Israeli strikes inside Iran resume, or Iran strikes US regional bases or Gulf states directly.	**–1 (24 → 23). The kinetic record is emptier than at any point in weeks and the primary source now says so in its own words:** UKMTO 087 records attack frequency as having **'remained consistent'** in an **'established post-MoU status quo'**, where 086 said it had increased. **CENTCOM is 23 days silent on combat inside Iran, no kinetic event is dated 20 or 21 August, and a carrier relief is under way without reported incident (Tier 2).** Against it: Bessent's regime-collapse formulation, and Ghalibaf concluding a three-day Iraq visit on 21 August (see 2.3). **Net one point down, and this is the first reduction in this cell since 17 August.**
Contained but violent	**21%**	Attacks continue on shipping and on Gulf energy infrastructure; the blockade persists; neither side crosses into sustained state-on-state strikes.	**+1 (20 → 21). This is the cell UKMTO has just described in its own assessment language.** 087 adds three incidents while holding every one of nine threat levels unchanged, the blockade tally moves by one to 65, and the Hormuz annex records three consecutive days of near-zero cargo movement. **A steady rate of attacks against an unchanged threat picture and a functioning blockade is the definition of this scenario, and the provider is now naming it a status quo.**
Regional relapse	**9%**	The conflict widens through the Red Sea, Lebanon, Iraq or the Saudi energy complex rather than through the strait itself.	**–1 (10 → 9). Arguing for a lower reading:** Ghalibaf's Iraq visit concludes on 21 August with no readout yet published from the Karbala or Najaf legs and nothing produced in Iraq or Lebanon; the Jazan claim is in its fourth day uncorroborated; the single Red Sea incident in 087 destroyed an unmanned hull; and Bab el-Mandeb traffic rose. **Arguing against a larger cut, and the reason this is held to one point:** the Iraqi militia axis remains in play, Al-Mokha stays closed, and the OFAC designations that did land reach into Turkey and the UAE.
Mediated pause	**3%**	A negotiated de-escalation restores partial transit under a supervised regime.	**unchanged (3), holding at the record low.** Two facts offset exactly. **Arguing up: Oman broke a twelve-day silence on Hormuz on 20 August**, jointly with Japan's foreign minister, calling for freedom of navigation and saying lasting security in the strait requires a lasting regional peace. **Arguing down: the item mentions neither the United States nor the bilateral track, the Iran–Oman joint declaration is still not issued, Qatar's gate has not opened, and the US Treasury Secretary has stated the objective as regime collapse. A mediator talking to Tokyo about navigation is not the same as a mediator convening the parties.**

Probabilities sum to 100. **Deal collapse and full war carry 67% between them, unchanged at the highest reading this map has recorded — but the composition rotated.** A point moved out of full war and into deal collapse: **the risk in this window migrated from violence to terms, which is what a week containing a declared economic war, no kinetic event and a 23-day combat silence should produce.** The contained-but-violent cell rose to its highest since 17 August on the strength of UKMTO's own assessment that the environment is now a status quo rather than an escalation.

6 · Watchlist · next 24–72 hours

1 · Whether Brent takes out $95 — and on the current post-roll basis it is the closest it has been. $3.03 on the scored continuation and $1.22 on the active close, after four consecutive editions of narrowing. The trigger requires **sustained closes, not a touch** (§4a), and the two bases are converging, so the active contract is the binding measure. **This is the only channel that can move the score UP, and the only one within a session's range of moving at all — the three documented downgrades sit 20.12 bp, 24.76 bp and 22 cents away.** Read the roll disclosure in 2.1 first. **2 · Whether Threshold B holds its fifth arming past one session.** Seven of the eight previous states lasted three closes or fewer and four lasted exactly one. **The margins are 4.76 and 5.41 bp, which is wider than the 0.89 and 0.34 that ended the last arming but still inside a single session's range. 3 · Whether the September Fed path repricing continues.** Thursday's data lifted the whole curve, the 2-year included; Musalem calls policy accommodative with inflation at 2.5–3%. **Jackson Hole runs 27–29 August, Warsh's first keynote Friday 28 August**, into a market pricing roughly a 68% hold — an aggregator reading, not a CME print. **4 · Whether Bessent's Hormuz sanctions actually issue, and whether they reach China.** The 20 August OFAC action was a Hizballah cash network. **Watch the OFAC recent-actions page and the Federal Register, not the rhetoric** — the target set Trump named on 19 August is financial institutions, businesses, airports and government entities, and specifically oil smuggling, swap lines, cash transfers, exchange houses, ship registries and front companies, and none of it has issued. Bessent declined to say whether China is included; China has already objected publicly. **5 · Whether Iran retaliates against the UAE embargo beyond a denial, and whether any other Gulf state follows. No UAE implementing decree, carve-out or licence regime has been published, which is the test of how binding it is**, and no Iranian retaliatory measure is dated 20 or 21 August. **6 · UKMTO Update 088 and VRA Overview No.3.** 087 broke a two-edition freeze and the annex now runs to 19 August, showing **Hormuz cargo transits of 0, 1 and 0 across three days**. Whether that is the run rate is the next annex's question. Update 081 is unretrievable for a seventh edition. **7 · Whether CENTCOM's combat silence breaks at 23 days.** Query the PUBLIC-RELEASES index, not the news-articles index, which is stale to February (§9.23). **It is the single largest reason full war fell to 23%.** Watch also whether the George Washington's arrival changes the operational tempo. **8 · Whether the Iran–Oman joint declaration is ever issued.** Oman has just published on Hormuz for the first time in twelve days but said nothing about the bilateral track. **Watch fm.gov.om, not Iranian spokesmen. 9 · Whether AUTMUSAG prints again at all.** Two dark sessions after backfilling to a two-and-a-half-month high, and DOE corroboration does not publish until 25 August. **§9.30: do not read a trend through dark sessions in either direction. 10 · The 26 August EIA weekly and GDPNow revision**, and whether the SPR draws again from 293.4 mn bbl, which EIA reports as the lowest since December 1982.

7 · Source log

Tier	Source	Used for
Tier 1 · market data	Bloomberg extract 'US Iran BBG Data.xlsx', refreshed 21 Aug 2026	All price, yield, volatility and gasoline series. **169 raw rows × 99 columns**; header row scanned, not hardcoded. Front-month auto-detect resolved CO2/CL2; DXY resolved as 'DXY Index'. The 27 Feb anchor was re-verified field by field and is unchanged. **The §9.8 row-level check CLEARS decisively. The §9.35 field-level check FIRES once, on the 30-year, which is reported UNRESOLVED with no d/d asserted. The CL2 continuation rolled on the 21 Aug row and the CLA column was restated across 3–20 August; both are disclosed in 1 and 2.1.** No series backfilled apart from AUTMUSAG for 19 Aug.
Tier 1 · US official primary	US Treasury Fiscal Data auctions API — releases R_20260819_2 (20-year, CUSIP 912810UX4) and R_20260820_3 (30-year TIPS, CUSIP 912810US5); Philadelphia Fed MBOS, August 2026; DOL initial claims; NAR existing home sales; Conference Board LEI; OFAC recent actions 20 Aug and Treasury release SB0611; EIA WPSR week ending 14 Aug; Atlanta Fed GDPNow (18 Aug)	**The full 20-year and 30-year TIPS auction internals, including the allotment splits on both denominators.** The 20 Aug macro actuals. The Hizballah/IRGC-QF designations and the absence of any Iranian oil, shipping or registry action. Crude, distillate and SPR levels. Q3 GDP tracking. **Note for future editions: the TreasuryDirect PDF endpoints return empty to a fetcher; the Fiscal Data auctions API is the working primary route and should be the standing method.**
Tier 1 · maritime and military primary	UKMTO/JMIC Update 087 (ICOD 201500Z) and its annex, read in full; UKMTO VRA Overview No.2 (14 Aug); centcom.mil public-releases index, read 21 Aug; fm.gov.om news and statements indexes, both read 21 Aug	The cumulative count of 94, incidents 116-26, 117-26 and 118-26, all nine threat levels, the changed assessment language, the Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb transit annex to 19 Aug, the NCAGS 48-hour figure, the six held vessels, and the CENTCOM blockade tally of 65 as of 19 Aug. **The 23-day gap since the last combat release inside Iran was verified against the public-releases index, not the news-articles index, which is stale to February 2026.** Oman's publication record was queried on four separate questions and each answer is stated with its query (§9.23).

Tier	Source	Used for
Tier 1 · news	CNBC and Al Jazeera/Reuters (20 Aug, Bessent); ABC News, Middle East Eye and The Hill (20 Aug, Araghchi); ABC, CNBC and Al Jazeera (19 Aug, Trump); Bloomberg and Al-Monitor (20 Aug, China MFA); Bloomberg and CNBC (20 Aug, Musalem); Reuters (20 Aug, oil); Bloomberg (18 Aug, diesel record); Al Jazeera (20 Aug, Kpler route split); Axios (19 Aug, convoy corridor); gasprices.aaa.com, read directly	The economic-war statements on both sides and China’s response; Fed commentary; the named oil attributions; retail fuel; the route split and its provider caveat; throughput claims. **Every anonymous-source claim is labelled as such where it is used.**
Tier 1 provider · commercial data	Kpler (blog 19 Aug, and via Al Jazeera 20 Aug); Windward (19 Aug transit, jamming and blockade-breaker panels); Lloyd’s List Intelligence (19 Aug Hormuz brief and TD3C); Marsh via S&P Global (22 Jul)	Transit counts with their own denominators, the dark/unknown route share, crude-on-water and Iranian loadings, the Chinese carrier withdrawal, Kharg activity, tanker earnings and war-risk premia. **Kpler’s own published revision factor of 1.5–2.0x on the most recent week is now the sourced basis for this monitor’s rule against computing a day-on-day off a same-day print.**
Tier 2 · secondary and trade	GlobalSecurity daily update (20 Aug); Washington Examiner citing CENTCOM (20 Aug); Tipswatch (20 Aug); CME FedWatch via aggregators; IMF PortWatch; Maritime Executive and INTERCARGO; straits.live	The 21st-night kinetic pause count, the George Washington arrival, TIPS auction and settlement colour, and September Fed pricing. **Every figure in this row is labelled Tier 2 at first use and here. The 21-night kinetic-pause count and the George Washington arrival are each restated later without the label and should be read as Tier 2 throughout. The ~68% September hold reading is from an aggregator and not a CME print. straits.live’s war-risk figure is its own model, not a broker quote, and is not carried.**
Tier 3 · state media	SABA (18 Aug, Jazan claim); Mehr and Fars/WANA by reference only	**Nothing in this edition is scored off a Tier 3 source.** The Houthi claim to have struck Jazan on 18 August is in its fourth day without Saudi, Aramco or Tier 1 corroboration and is carried as a claim only. Iranian claims to have detained the tanker AMARA and turned back a Chinese tanker are Tier 3 in origin; the underlying vessel movements are independently observed by Windward and Bloomberg and only the observations are used.
Rejected, withdrawn or unresolved this edition	Listed for audit	**B’s lapse read as persisting, the Treasury legs’ convergence read as a trend, and the dollar’s three-month low read as a trend** — all three TREND readings withdrawn by name after the 20 August close; the 19 August facts themselves stand (§9.20, §9.31). **An ADNOC-vessel attack dated Friday 21 August** — the source page is dated 14 August; rejected. **A ‘17.4 mn bbl’ crude build attributed to ING** — a garble of the 17.4 mn b/d refinery-input line; the actual build was 4.4 mn bbl; not used. **The derived ≈$101.2 diesel crack for 19 August** — not repeated as an observation; no crack has been published for three sessions. **A 0.5 bp 20-year tail** — cannot be confirmed from any Treasury source and is not asserted. **UKMTO 086’s date of 17 August** — corrected to 18 August. **The ‘91 vessels redirected’ CENTCOM caption** — still irreconcilable with its own 65; still not used. **Lloyd’s List weekly figures of 84 and 78** — a secondary summary conflicts with the provider’s own 73 and 91; the provider’s numbers are used. **The DOE weekly retail values of $4.049 and $5.454** — could not be re-verified outside the terminal for a second edition and are carried with that flag. Also unresolved: incidents 115-26 and 116-26 as one fatal attack or two (the numbering says two). **Standing items carried forward but NOT relied on in this edition’s body:** the Sinokor VLCC named as Singapore Prosperity or Bulgaria Prosperity; the Iranian claim to have detained the tanker AMARA; the pre-2026 diesel-crack record ($89 or $86.82); the distillate-stocks comparison (1996 or 1998); the Baltic week-34 averages, not obtained.

8 · On-demand update protocol

#	Step	Detail
1	Refresh and integrity-check the extract	Scan the header row rather than hardcoding columns; auto-detect the Brent and WTI front month. Run the row-level stale check (§9.8) by diffing the prior row against the figures published for it, and the field-level check (§9.35) for values identical to four decimals. **Add a basis check: compare the continuation against the active contract for every energy benchmark, because a roll breaks the series silently (§9.36). This edition: the row check clears, the field check FIRES on the 30-year, and the basis check caught a WTI roll and a CLA restatement.**
2	Compute deltas and test every trigger explicitly	d/d against the last confirmed close, w/w against five sheet-rows back, and vs the 27 Feb anchor re-verified field by field. Test all four market channels and Stage-4 A, B and C on the confirmed close only, and record the distance in basis points or dollars so the direction of travel is visible edition to edition. **Run min, max and last-prior-occurrence queries on the full series before writing any superlative drawn from the EXTRACT (§9.32); superlatives on off-extract series — the Philadelphia Fed, the SPR, the auction records — are attributed to the publisher that made them.** Every extract superlative here was checked that way and two were narrowed before printing.
3	Verify the news on both tracks and re-verify what was inherited	Military and diplomatic on one track, shipping, energy and macro on the other. **Re-run negative claims every edition they are repeated (§9.23)** — absence-of-evidence decays faster than positive facts, and this edition proves it twice: UKMTO published after two frozen editions, and Oman published after twelve days. State the exact query alongside the answer. Where several trackers disagree, publish every number with its denominator and take no average (§9.24).
4	Reconcile the previous snapshot and withdraw conclusions by name	The Singapore-morning cut regularly misses the US session, in either direction and sometimes in both at once. **This edition's cut understated every reconciled field bar one, all the same way, so three conclusions built on it are withdrawn by name rather than quietly restated (§9.20, §9.31).** Test every field for carry-status before it enters a reconciliation, and publish the exclusions (§9.37); none were needed this time.
5	Score on confirmed closes, with hysteresis, and explain the composition	Never move a market channel on an intraday print; never whipsaw on a single session; never move a downgrade rule to match the level that fired the upgrade. When the scale is saturated, say so — the total registers neither deterioration nor improvement (§9.7, §9.27), so the analysis has to carry what the number cannot. **This edition: the incident count rose by three, the kinetic record went empty, the US declared an objective of regime collapse, and the score is flat at 27 for an eleventh time.**

9 · Methodology

Data. All market series come from a single Bloomberg extract refreshed by the user each working day. The sheet is parsed by scanning its header row rather than by column position, because tickers are relabelled and columns inserted between uploads. **The latest row is an intraday snapshot taken on the Singapore morning; the row before it is the last confirmed close, and every score test in this document runs on the confirmed close.** History is restated by the vendor from time to time — this edition the WTI active-contract column, across 3–20 August — so absolute levels are not comparable with pre-restatement editions while directional analysis is continuous. **Three integrity checks now run every edition.** The row-level check (§9.8) diffs the prior row against the figures published for it. The field-level check (§9.35) treats any field printing identical to four decimals against the previous session as UNRESOLVED and asserts no day-on-day change for it, **regardless of whether the row around it is live**; it fires on the 30-year here, the second time it has caught that series and the reason the rule exists. **The third is new in practice: a basis check of each continuation series against its active contract, because a roll breaks a continuation silently and a trigger measured across one is not comparable either side of it (§9.36).** It caught a WTI roll that would otherwise have printed as a $2.46 fall. **Missing prints are labelled, never carried forward as fresh, and re-checked next edition for backfill. Scoring.** Six channels, each 0 to 5, summed to 0–30. Two channels are event-driven and four are market-driven. **Market channels move only on confirmed closes, never on an intraday print**, and event channels move only on events, not announcements: a declared posture, a stated objective, an unissued declaration or a trailed sanctions package is not an event (§9.11). **Hysteresis is asymmetric by design.** An upgrade fires on a sustained break of a stated level; the corresponding downgrade requires a sustained reversal past a wider one. **This edition is the strongest vindication of that property the document has produced:** the previous session's 9 bp long-end rally, its lapsed Stage-4 threshold and its three-month dollar low were all undone or materially given back within one close — 62% of the rally, the lapse entirely, the dollar low as a trend — and no score moved on any of them, because none met a documented rule. **The cost is also visible** — the US-inflation channel fired on a 2.30% break in the 5y5y forward and its documented downgrade sits at the 2.142% pre-war anchor, 20.12 bp below Thursday's close. **The gap is reported rather than closed, and the rule is not moved to match the tape** (§9.16, §9.26). **The saturation problem.** Maritime denial and escalation risk have both been at 5 since early July. **Further deterioration in either cannot raise the total, so a flat score is an artifact of the scale** (§9.7); the same failure runs in reverse when everything improves (§9.27). **This edition is a fourth variant: the two capped channels moved in OPPOSITE directions** — three new confirmed incidents against an empty kinetic record and a 23-day combat silence — **and the total could register neither, nor a Treasury Secretary saying on television that the intent is to collapse the Iranian government. Sourcing.** Every factual claim carries an attribution and a tier. State media is labelled Tier 3 and is never used for anything market-moving without Tier 1 corroboration. **Negative claims are re-verified at source every edition they are repeated, with the exact query stated** (§9.23). **That paid twice this week: UKMTO published Update 087 after two frozen editions and Oman published on Hormuz after twelve days, and carrying either negative forward would have missed both. Where trackers disagree, every number is published with its own denominator and no average is taken** (§9.24) — a rule that now extends to auction allotments, where 62.93% and 62.17% are the same award measured against competitive accepted and against total award. **Extract superlatives are checked against the full series before they are written** (§9.32), and inherited claims are re-verified on the same schedule as new ones (§9.13). **Where the previous edition built a conclusion on a snapshot that the close then contradicted, the conclusion is withdrawn by name** (§9.20, §9.31); three are withdrawn as trends here. **And where a threshold's written test depends on a figure that its primary source structurally does not publish — as Stage-4 Threshold A now does, since Treasury never releases a when-issued level — the test is untestable rather than merely unverified,**

and §9.21 and §9.33 require it to be replaced rather than left pending. That is recorded here as an open item.